SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

18 July 2022 · Shift 1

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Below the belt

(A) Without any effort
(B) Very quickly
(C) Cruel and unfair
(D) Suspiciously

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Her forty-fourth birthday “had just passed, unnoticed by all but herself.”

(A) had just passed, unnoticed by but all herself
(B) has just passed, unnoticed by all herself
(C) has just passed, unnoticed by but all herself
(D) No improvement required

Q.3

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. He sat down in a darkly corner and covered his face, and would not say a single word to anyone.

(A) No error
(B) and covered his face, and would
(C) He sat down in a darkly corner
(D) not say a single word to anyone

Q.4

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. The goons fled after kill a boy in the street.

(A) No error
(B) boy in the street
(C) after kill a
(D) The goons fled

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. She smashed a _____ of glass with the metal vase.

(A) pion
(B) pawn
(C) pane
(D) pain

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I have visited _____ coaching institutes in your region.

(A) many
(B) mostly
(C) much
(D) any

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Vanish

(A) Disappear
(B) Depart
(C) Conquer
(D) Emerge

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Acute

(A) Obtuse
(B) Faithful
(C) Chronic
(D) Dire

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Keep body and soul together

(A) Live happily
(B) Live as long as possible
(C) Be mentally and physically fit
(D) Stay alive during hard times

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. That fellow pushed me so hard that my vision got _____ for a second.

(A) simplified
(B) illuminated
(C) exposed
(D) blurred

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I organised my dressing table by putting all the rubber bands _____ the drawer.

(A) for
(B) in
(C) on
(D) at

Q.12

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Next month, she “was going to” the institute to study for a master's degree.

(A) went to
(B) has gone to
(C) is going to
(D) No improvement required

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. He blew out the candle and “went to sleepy.”

(A) went to sleep
(B) go on sleep
(C) No improvement required
(D) gone to sleep

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. Simon had always been an “ardent” follower.

(A) averse
(B) objective
(C) casual
(D) passionate

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Most mainliners do not view modern culture as inherently _____ to religious belief.

(A) inimical
(B) inchoate
(C) inconclusive
(D) inadvertent

Q.16

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. A number of measres have been sugested by her.

(A) A number of measrues have been sugessted by her.
(B) A number of measures have been sujjested by her.
(C) A number of measures have been suggested by her.
(D) A number of mesures have been suggested by her.

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Outstanding

(A) Astounding
(B) Ordinary
(C) Remarkable
(D) Honest

Q.18

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Chauffeur
(B) specielist
(C) Anchor
(D) Compere

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. _____ I learned that there was a gift for each child, I was delighted.

(A) When
(B) Though
(C) While
(D) Which

Q.20

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Both of my parents are dependent on my salary of their living.

(A) are dependent on my
(B) Both of my parents
(C) salary of their living
(D) No error

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Many forests are cleared to (1) _____ way for palm oil plantations. Palm oil is the most (2) _____ produced vegetable oil and is found in half of all supermarket products. It's cheap, versatile and can be added to (3) _____ food and personal products like lipsticks and shampoo. (4) _____ popularity has (5) _____ people to clear tropical forests to grow more palm trees.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) made
(B) take
(C) make
(D) give

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Many forests are cleared to (1) _____ way for palm oil plantations. Palm oil is the most (2) _____ produced vegetable oil and is found in half of all supermarket products. It's cheap, versatile and can be added to (3) _____ food and personal products like lipsticks and shampoo. (4) _____ popularity has (5) _____ people to clear tropical forests to grow more palm trees.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) commonly
(B) casually
(C) lovingly
(D) usually

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Many forests are cleared to (1) _____ way for palm oil plantations. Palm oil is the most (2) _____ produced vegetable oil and is found in half of all supermarket products. It's cheap, versatile and can be added to (3) _____ food and personal products like lipsticks and shampoo. (4) _____ popularity has (5) _____ people to clear tropical forests to grow more palm trees.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) both
(B) each
(C) one
(D) between

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Many forests are cleared to (1) _____ way for palm oil plantations. Palm oil is the most (2) _____ produced vegetable oil and is found in half of all supermarket products. It's cheap, versatile and can be added to (3) _____ food and personal products like lipsticks and shampoo. (4) _____ popularity has (5) _____ people to clear tropical forests to grow more palm trees.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Our
(B) Its
(C) It's
(D) Their

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Many forests are cleared to (1) _____ way for palm oil plantations. Palm oil is the most (2) _____ produced vegetable oil and is found in half of all supermarket products. It's cheap, versatile and can be added to (3) _____ food and personal products like lipsticks and shampoo. (4) _____ popularity has (5) _____ people to clear tropical forests to grow more palm trees.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) baffled
(B) delighted
(C) curated
(D) prompted

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
4, 34, 58, 76, 88, ?

(A) 94
(B) 96
(C) 98
(D) 92

Q.2

In a certain code language, 'PEARL' is coded as '24153', 'EARTH' is coded as '41590' and 'PILE' is coded as '2634'. What is the code for the word 'HEAR' in that language?

(A) 2651
(B) 0415
(C) 1520
(D) 9054

Q.3

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. TOR, ?, VQT, WRU, XSV

(A) UPS
(B) VPS
(C) VPT
(D) UNS

Q.4

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 35 + 7 × 12 – 6 ÷ 2 = 6

(A) – and ×
(B) – and ÷
(C) + and ×
(D) × and ÷

Q.5

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (8, 4, 1); (12, 4, 5)

(A) (44, 20, 20)
(B) (20, 2, 12)
(C) (17, 8, 6)
(D) (33, 10, 21)

Q.7

By interchanging the given two signs ÷ and –, which of the following equations will be correct? I. 143 + 6 × 18 ÷ 45 – 3 = 236; II. 133 – 7 + 16 × 11 ÷ 37 = 158

(A) Both I and II
(B) Only I
(C) Only II
(D) Neither I nor II

Q.8

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some festivals are fireworks. No cracker is a firework. No bomb is a festival. Conclusions: I. No bomb is a cracker. II. Some bombs are crackers.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Either conclusion I or II follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.9

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statement I: All mobiles are electronics. Statement II: All laptops are electronics. Conclusion I: Some mobiles are laptops. Conclusion II: All mobiles are laptops.

(A) Either conclusion I or II follows.
(B) Only conclusion II follows.
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. RNP : SOQ :: CSN : DTO :: EJM : ?

(A) FKO
(B) FKL
(C) FKN
(D) FLN

Q.11

In a certain code language, 'HAPREB' is written as 'IEUQAW', and 'GBCDFA' is written as 'HFHCBV'. How will 'QRPLAC' be written in that language?

(A) RVUKWX
(B) RVUJWX
(C) RVUJXW
(D) RVUKXW

Q.12

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 125 : 25 :: 64 : 16 :: 216 : ?

(A) 36
(B) 24
(C) 22
(D) 39

Q.15

Six students, Riya, Mala, Ambika, Kajal, Heena and Sanya, are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Ambika is sitting third to the right of Heena. Riya is the immediate neighbour of Heena and Kajal. Mala is not the immediate neighbour of Heena. Kajal is to the immediate right of Ambika.Who is sitting second to the right of Riya?

(A) Sanya
(B) Mala
(C) Kajal
(D) Heena

Q.16

Among five friends P, Q, R, S and T, T is taller than only three other friends. R is the tallest among all friends. Q is taller than only one person. Only two persons are taller than P. Who is the shortest among all the friends?

(A) T
(B) P
(C) Q
(D) S

Q.17

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in it. (8, 4, 48), (3, 6, 36), (8, 6, ?)

(A) 52
(B) 14
(C) 28
(D) 56

Q.19

In a certain code language, 'ELITE' is coded as '3', and 'BLUE' is coded as '2'. How will 'ABSENCE' be coded in that language?

(A) 4
(B) 2
(C) 3
(D) 1

Q.21

In a certain code language, if 'sky' is known as 'earth', 'earth' is known as 'water', 'water' is known as 'air', 'air' is known as 'light', and 'light' is known as 'sound', then what is it that humans breathe in?

(A) Air
(B) Earth
(C) Light
(D) Water

Q.23

Six books Hindi, Biology, Mathematics, Economics, Physics, Chemistry are placed in two racks facing each other with three books in each rack. Hindi and Chemistry are in the same rack but are not neighbours. Biology is placed exactly opposite to Economics. Biology is just left of Hindi facing South direction. Physics is exactly opposite to Chemistry. Which of the following is placed exactly opposite to Hindi?

(A) Chemistry
(B) Economics
(C) Biology
(D) Mathematics

Q.24

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. TNG : RLD :: LAC : ?

(A) JYA
(B) JXZ
(C) JYZ
(D) JXA

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. THROUGH : UJUSZMO :: COSTUME : ?

(A) DQYXZSL
(B) DQWXZSL
(C) DQVXZSL
(D) DQVXZSK

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

The lowest known point on earth is called _____, which is present in the Pacific Ocean.

(A) Factorial Deep
(B) Challenger Deep
(C) Great Blue Hole
(D) Great Barrier Reef

Q.2

Renowned Indian classical dancer Mrinalini Sarabhai was awarded with the _____ in 1965.

(A) Padma Bhushan
(B) Padma Vibhushan
(C) Kalidas Samman
(D) Padma Shri

Q.3

Which of the following sports was NOT played at the 2020 Summer Olympic Games (Held in 2021)?

(A) Bridge
(B) Tennis
(C) Basketball
(D) Judo

Q.4

The Satnami Movement in Central India had a motive to:

(A) improve social status of leatherworkers
(B) ban child marriage
(C) open school for girls
(D) improve widow status

Q.5

Under which Act was the Supreme court established in India?

(A) Regulating Act of 1773
(B) Pitt's India Act 1784
(C) Charter Act of 1853
(D) Charter Act of 1793

Q.6

Who is the author of the book 'Fearless Governance'?

(A) Kiran Bedi
(B) Jaswant Singh
(C) Arun Shourie
(D) MJ Akbar

Q.7

Which of the following is an example of a public sector bank in India?

(A) Federal Bank
(B) HDFC Bank
(C) Axis Bank
(D) Punjab National Bank

Q.8
Which of the following was an integral part of the Indo-Islamic form of architecture?

(A) Domes
(B) Shutter windows
(C) Tall and steep slopes
(D) Square roofs

Q.9
Which scheme of Rajasthan launched in 2022 provides the rural girls of the state with scholarship schemes?

(A) Udaan
(B) STARS Project
(C) SAMARTH
(D) Vision 2035

Q.10
Who among the following was the first ruler of the Gupta dynasty to adopt the grand title of Maharaj-adhiraja?

(A) Skandagupta
(B) Samudragupta
(C) Chandragupta I
(D) Vishnugupta

Q.11
As of April 2022, what is the capital of India's neighbouring country Myanmar?

(A) Dhaka
(B) Naypyidaw
(C) Thimphu
(D) Beijing

Q.12
Laho is a folk dance of _____.

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Manipur
(C) Kerala
(D) Maharashtra

Q.13
Which Article provides freedom to manage its own affairs in matters of religion?

(A) Article 210
(B) Article 5
(C) Article 26
(D) Article 370

Q.14
Who among the following was the first Indian to win an individual gold medal at the Olympic Games?

(A) Abhinav Bindra
(B) Saina Nehwal
(C) Anju Bobby George
(D) Mahesh Bhupathi

Q.15
Which of the following is the largest gland in the human body?

(A) Pancreas
(B) Pineal
(C) Liver
(D) Hypothalamus

Q.16
Who has the power to abolish or create legislative council in the state?

(A) Parliament
(B) High court of the concerned state
(C) President
(D) Chief minister of the concerned state

Q.17
Which of the following festivals is devoted to worshiping of the Sun and celebrated mainly by the people of Bihar?

(A) Bohag Bihu
(B) Ugadi
(C) Chhath Puja
(D) Lohri

Q.18
Swarnajayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (SGSY) was launched in _____.

(A) 1994
(B) 1999
(C) 1992
(D) 1995

Q.19
Cobalt therapy is the medical use of _____ rays from the radioisotope cobalt-60 to treat conditions such as cancer.

(A) alpha
(B) beta
(C) gamma
(D) Ultraviolet

Q.20
Amjad Ali Khan is associated with which instrument?

(A) Veena
(B) Nadaswaram
(C) Sarangi
(D) Sarod

Q.21
In coastal areas, during the night, wind blows from land to sea because:

(A) low pressure is created on land
(B) land cools slower than water
(C) water cools slower than land
(D) high pressure is created at sea

Q.22
'Kathakali' is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

(A) Manipur
(B) Kerala
(C) Karnataka
(D) Assam

Q.23
Which state is the leading producer of sugarcane in India, as of April 2022?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Telangana
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.24
Which organelle is found both in eukaryotic and prokaryotic cells?

(A) Ribosome
(B) Golgi bodies
(C) Mitochondria
(D) Lysosome

Q.25
Who defeated Maharana Pratap in the Battle of Haldighati in 1576?

(A) Jahangir
(B) Harihara I
(C) Akbar
(D) Nizam Shah

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Cruel and unfair

To hit 'below the belt' is to act in a cruel and unfair way, like an illegal low punch in boxing.

Q.2 · Answer (D) No improvement required

The sentence is correct as it stands: 'had just passed' fits the past narrative, and 'unnoticed by all but herself' means noticed by no one except her. The options muddle the word order or drop 'but'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) He sat down in a darkly corner

'Darkly' is an adverb; the noun 'corner' needs the adjective: 'in a dark corner'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) after kill a

After the preposition 'after', the verb takes the '-ing' form: 'fled after killing a boy'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) pane

A 'pane' is a sheet of glass, as in a window; 'pain' only sounds like it.

Q.6 · Answer (A) many

'Many' goes with plural countable nouns such as 'institutes'; 'much' is for uncountable nouns, and 'any' belongs in questions and negatives.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Emerge

To 'vanish' is to disappear; its opposite is to 'emerge', to come into view.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Dire

'Acute' means severe or serious, as in an acute shortage, which is close to 'dire'. 'Chronic' and 'obtuse' are its opposites in other senses.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Stay alive during hard times

To 'keep body and soul together' is to earn just enough to stay alive in hard times.

Q.10 · Answer (D) blurred

A hard push can leave one's sight 'blurred', that is unclear, for a moment.

Q.11 · Answer (B) in

Things are put 'in' a drawer, an enclosed space.

Q.12 · Answer (C) is going to

'Next month' points to the future, so a planned action takes the present continuous: 'she is going to the institute'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) went to sleep

After 'went to' the noun 'sleep' is needed, not the adjective 'sleepy': 'went to sleep'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) passionate

'Ardent' means passionate or enthusiastic; 'averse' and 'casual' are nearly its opposites.

Q.15 · Answer (A) inimical

'Inimical' means hostile or harmful: modern culture is not seen as hostile to religious belief. 'Inchoate' means only just begun and 'inadvertent' unintended.

Q.16 · Answer (C) A number of measures have been suggested by her.

The words are 'measures' and 'suggested', with a double 'g'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Ordinary

'Outstanding' means exceptionally good; its opposite is 'ordinary'. 'Astounding' and 'remarkable' are close to it in meaning.

Q.18 · Answer (B) specielist
The correct spelling is 'specialist'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) When
'When' introduces a clause of time: on learning of the gifts, the speaker was delighted. 'Though' would wrongly suggest a contrast.

Q.20 · Answer (C) salary of their living
One depends on something 'for' a living: 'dependent on my salary for their living'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) make
To 'make way for' something is to clear space for it: forests are cleared to make way for plantations.

Q.22 · Answer (A) commonly
Palm oil is the 'most commonly produced' vegetable oil, that is the one produced most widely.

Q.23 · Answer (A) both
'Both' introduces the pair 'food and personal products'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Its
'Its', the possessive, refers to palm oil's popularity; 'it's' means 'it is'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) prompted
Its popularity has 'prompted', or led, people to clear tropical forests.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) 94
The differences are 30, 24, 18, 12, falling by 6, so the next is 6: 88 + 6 = 94.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 0415
Letter by letter, PEARL → 24153 and EARTH → 41590 give P = 2, E = 4, A = 1, R = 5, L = 3, T = 9 and H = 0, and PILE → 2634 agrees. So HEAR → 0415.

Q.3 · Answer (A) UPS
The first letters run T, U, V, W, X, the second O, P, Q, R, S and the third R, S, T, U, V: UPS.

Q.4 · Answer (A) – and ×
Interchanging – and × gives 35 + 7 – 12 × 6 ÷ 2 = 35 + 7 – 36 = 6.

Q.5 · Answer (C) (17, 8, 6)
In each set the first number minus the second, minus 3, gives the third: 8 – 4 – 3 = 1 and 12 – 4 – 3 = 5. Only 17 – 8 – 3 = 6 fits; the other sets would need 21, 15 and 20.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Both I and II
With ÷ and – interchanged, I becomes 143 + 6 × 18 – 45 ÷ 3 = 143 + 108 – 15 = 236 and II becomes 133 ÷ 7 + 16 × 11 – 37 = 19 + 176 – 37 = 158, so both are correct.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Either conclusion I or II follows
No statement links bombs with crackers, so neither conclusion follows on its own. But 'No bomb is a cracker' and 'Some bombs are crackers' cover every case between them, so either I or II follows.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
Mobiles and laptops are both inside electronics, but nothing says they overlap, so neither 'some' nor 'all' mobiles being laptops follows. The two conclusions are not a complementary pair, so 'either-or' does not apply.

Q.10 · Answer (C) FKN
Each letter moves forward 1: RNP → SOQ and CSN → DTO. So EJM → FKN.

Q.11 · Answer (A) RVUKWX
The letters move +1, +4, +5, –1, –4, –5 in turn: HAPREB → IEUQAW and GBCDFA → HFHCBV (A – 5 wraps round to V). So QRPLAC → RVUKWX.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 36
Each first number is a cube and the second the square of the same root: 125 = 5^3 and 25 = 5^2, 64 = 4^3 and 16 = 4^2. So 216 = 6^3 gives 6^2 = 36.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Sanya
Ambika sits opposite Heena, Kajal to Ambika's immediate right and Riya between Heena and Kajal. Mala cannot sit next to Heena, so she takes the seat beside Ambika and Sanya the one beside Heena. Going right from Riya come Heena and then Sanya.

Q.16 · Answer (D) S
R is the tallest and T, taller than three, is second; only two are taller than P, so P is third, and Q, taller than only one, is fourth. That leaves S the shortest.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 56
The third number is four times the sum of the first two: (8 + 4) × 4 = 48 and (3 + 6) × 4 = 36. So (8 + 6) × 4 = 56.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 3
The code is the number of vowels: ELITE has E, I, E (3) and BLUE has U, E (2). ABSENCE has A, E, E: 3.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Light
Humans breathe in air, and in this code air is called 'light'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Mathematics
Hindi and Chemistry share a rack without being neighbours, so they are at its two ends, and Biology, just left of Hindi, is in the middle. In the facing rack Economics is opposite Biology and Physics opposite Chemistry, which leaves Mathematics opposite Hindi.

Q.24 · Answer (C) JYZ
The letters move back 2, 2 and 3: T → R, N → L, G → D. So L → J, A → Y, C → Z: JYZ.

Q.25 · Answer (C) DQVXZSL
The letters move forward 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7: THROUGH → UJUSZMO. So C → D, O → Q, S → V, T → X, U → Z, M → S and E → L: DQVXZSL.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Challenger Deep
The Challenger Deep, at the southern end of the Mariana Trench in the western Pacific, is the deepest known point of the Earth's seabed, nearly 11 km down.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Padma Shri
Mrinalini Sarabhai, the dancer who founded the Darpana Academy of Performing Arts in Ahmedabad, received the Padma Shri in 1965 and the Padma Bhushan in 1992.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Bridge
Bridge is not an Olympic sport (it was a medal event at the 2018 Asian Games); tennis, basketball and judo were all contested at Tokyo.

Q.4 · Answer (A) improve social status of leatherworkers
The Satnami movement, founded by Ghasidas in central India, worked among the leatherworkers and sought to improve their social status.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Regulating Act of 1773
The Regulating Act of 1773 provided for a Supreme Court at Calcutta (Fort William), which was set up in 1774.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Kiran Bedi
'Fearless Governance' is by Kiran Bedi, the former IPS officer, and draws on her years as Lieutenant Governor of Puducherry (2016-2021).

Q.7 · Answer (D) Punjab National Bank
Punjab National Bank is a public sector (nationalised) bank; Federal Bank, HDFC Bank and Axis Bank are private sector banks.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Domes
Domes and arches, with minarets, were the hallmarks of Indo-Islamic architecture, which brought the arcuate style in place of the older post-and-beam (trabeate) building.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Udaan
SSC's key gives Udaan, the Rajasthan government's project with the consulting group IPE Global that keeps rural girls in school by enrolling them at the secondary level and sees that the eligible ones get their scholarships. The project had been running in the state for some years before 2022, the year the question gives.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Chandragupta I
Chandragupta I was the first Gupta ruler to take the title Maharajadhiraja; his predecessors Sri Gupta and Ghatotkacha were styled Maharaja.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Naypyidaw
Naypyidaw has been Myanmar's capital since 2005-06, when the government moved there from Yangon. Dhaka is the capital of Bangladesh and Thimphu of Bhutan.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Meghalaya
Laho, also called the Chipiah dance, is a folk dance of the Pnar (Jaintia) people of Meghalaya, in which men and women dance with linked arms.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Article 26
Article 26 gives every religious denomination the freedom to manage its own affairs in matters of religion, to set up institutions and to own and administer property.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Abhinav Bindra
Abhinav Bindra won India's first individual Olympic gold, in the 10 m air rifle at Beijing in 2008.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Liver
The liver is the largest gland in the human body; it makes bile and stores glycogen.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Parliament
Under Article 169, Parliament can create or abolish a state's Legislative Council by law, once the state's Legislative Assembly asks for it by a resolution passed by a special majority.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Chhath Puja
Chhath Puja, devoted to the Sun god, is celebrated mainly in Bihar, Jharkhand and eastern Uttar Pradesh.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 1999
Swarnajayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana began on 1 April 1999, merging IRDP, TRYSEM and other self-employment programmes; it was restructured as the National Rural Livelihoods Mission in 2011.

Q.19 · Answer (C) gamma
Cobalt-60 gives off gamma rays, which cobalt therapy aims at tumours to kill cancer cells.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Sarod
Ustad Amjad Ali Khan is a sarod player of the Bangash gharana, son of Ustad Hafiz Ali Khan.

Q.21 · Answer (C) water cools slower than land
At night land cools faster than the sea, so the air over land is cooler and at higher pressure than over the water, and the land breeze blows out to sea.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Kerala
Kathakali is the classical dance-drama of Kerala.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Uttar Pradesh
Uttar Pradesh was India's largest producer of sugarcane when the exam was held (July 2022), ahead of Maharashtra.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Ribosome
Ribosomes, which make proteins, occur in both prokaryotic (70S) and eukaryotic (80S) cells; Golgi bodies, mitochondria and lysosomes are membrane-bound organelles found only in eukaryotes.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Akbar
At Haldighati in June 1576 Akbar's Mughal army, commanded by Raja Man Singh of Amber, defeated Maharana Pratap of Mewar.

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